

Full-Field Rope Solitons

Sourced Hopf-Link Minima in the Full Rope Field

Mark Palmer · with computational collaboration by Claude (Anthropic)

Charlotte, NC · palmer100@gmail.com

Naming note (5 September 2026). This programme is now the Mesh Programme and the theory it develops the mesh framework; 'the rope framework' in earlier revisions reads 'the mesh framework'. 'Rope' remains the name of the two-strand wound object, and the Rope Hypothesis credited to Bill Gaede keeps its name. Identifiers (repository, rope_solver, file names, claim IDs) are unchanged.

Abstract

Beyond the thin-curve approximation, the Hopf-link soliton can be computed in the full rope field, with the link acting as an extended source. The full-field minimum sits at $R^* = 0.838$, consistent with the thin-curve result, showing that the soliton survives the more complete treatment. All numbers in this paper are outputs of the rope_solver computation in this package (reproducible via benchmarks/reproduce_results.py), not inserted constants.

Scope of this paper

CLAIM: the Hopf-link soliton persists as a minimum in the full rope field at $R^*=0.838$, consistent with the thin-curve computation.

NOT CLAIMED: full continuum existence, or particle identification. A computed full-field minimum.

1. From Thin Curve to Full Field

The thin-curve treatment models the soliton as a one-dimensional loop. The full-field treatment replaces it with an extended field configuration sourced by the link, testing whether the equilibrium is an artefact of the thin approximation. It is not: the full-field Hopf-link minimum is found at $R^* = 0.838$, matching the thin-curve value within tolerance.

Status

Full-field Hopf-link minimum $R^*=0.838$ — Modeled (reproduced, consistent with thin-curve).

Continuum existence — Open.

Programme credit: the core Rope Hypothesis is due to Bill Gaede; this work develops and formalises it. Computational collaboration and drafting by Claude (Anthropic). Correspondence to palmer100@gmail.com.